

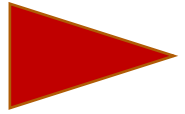
State, Government & Civil Society

Week 2

Rabia Zia

rabia.zia@nu.edu.pk





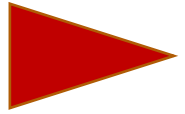
What is a State?

A state is a political entity with a defined territory, a permanent population, a government, and the ability to enter into relations with other states. It has sovereignty, meaning it has full control over its affairs without external interference.

Key Characteristics of a State

- **Territory:** A specific geographical area with recognized borders.
- **Population:** A group of people living within the state's territory.
- **Government:** A system of institutions that makes and enforces laws.
- **Sovereignty:** The ability to govern independently without external control.

Example: Pakistan, the United States, and France are all states because they have defined borders, governments, populations, and sovereignty.



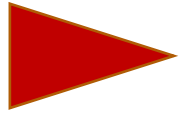
Are Country and State the Same Thing?

No, country and state are not exactly the same, but they are often used interchangeably in casual conversation.

Aspect	State	Country
Definition	A political and legal entity with four elements: territory, population, government, and sovereignty.	A geographical or cultural entity defined by shared identity, history, or traditions.
Sovereignty	Always sovereign, with full independence and authority over internal and external affairs.	May or may not be sovereign; can exist within a larger state.
Government	Has its own government and institutions to make and enforce laws.	May not have an independent government and can rely on another state's governance.
Recognition	Recognized under international law as a sovereign entity.	Used in everyday language; not always formally recognized as sovereign.
Examples	Pakistan, France, Japan → both states and countries.	Scotland (country, not a state), Puerto Rico (territory often called a "country").

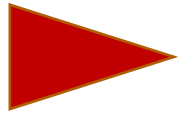
Clarification with Examples

- A country can exist without being a fully sovereign state
- Example: Scotland is a country, but it is not a state because it is part of the United Kingdom.
- A state is always sovereign, while a country may not be
- Example: Puerto Rico is a country but not a sovereign state because it is a U.S. territory.
- Some entities are both a state and a country
- Example: Pakistan, France, and Japan are both countries and states because they have sovereignty, defined borders, and a government.



What is the Deep State?

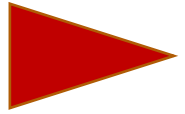
- The deep state refers to a hidden or unofficial network of powerful individuals or institutions within the government, military, intelligence, or bureaucracy that operates independently of elected officials. The deep state can influence major policies, resist change, or manipulate political events.
- **Characteristics**
 - Composed of intelligence agencies, military, powerful bureaucrats, or business elites.
 - Operates in secrecy, often resisting government policies that go against its interests.
 - May influence national security, foreign policy, and political stability.
- **Examples of Deep State Influence (Alleged or Real)**
 - **United States:** Some believe the CIA and intelligence agencies have influenced foreign policy beyond elected government control.
 - **Pakistan:** The military and intelligence agencies have historically played a strong role in national politics, sometimes overriding civilian government decisions.
 - **Turkey:** The term Derin Devlet (Deep State) refers to military and bureaucratic groups that influenced politics behind the scenes.



What is Government?

- A government is an institution or system through which a state is administered and controlled. It is responsible for making laws, enforcing them, and managing public affairs.
- **Key Functions of Government**
 - **Legislation:** Creating laws and policies.
 - **Execution:** Implementing and enforcing laws.
 - **Adjudication:** Resolving disputes through a judiciary system.
 - **Public Services:** Providing essential services like education, healthcare, and security.

Feature	State	Government
Definition	A permanent political entity with a defined territory, population, and sovereignty.	The administrative system that runs the state and enforces laws.
Scope	Broader concept – includes population, territory, sovereignty, and government.	Narrower – one part of the state responsible for governance.
Permanence	Permanent (unless it is dissolved or divided).	Temporary (Governments change with elections, revolutions, or reforms).
Example	Pakistan is a state.	The Government of Pakistan (such as the PTI or PML-N government) runs the state.



Forms & Systems of Government

Governments are structured in different ways to manage a country effectively.

Forms of Government (Based on Who Holds Power)

Democracy: Power belongs to the people, either directly or through elected representatives. (e.g., USA, India)

Monarchy: A king or queen rules, sometimes with constitutional limits. (e.g., UK, Saudi Arabia)

Dictatorship: One person or a small group holds absolute power. (e.g., North Korea)

Theocracy: Government is based on religious principles and led by religious figures. (e.g., Iran)

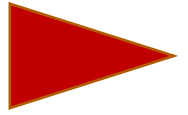
Systems of Government (Based on Power Distribution)

Unitary System: Central government holds all power. (e.g., France)

Federal System: Power is shared between central and local governments. (e.g., USA, Pakistan)

Parliamentary System: The executive (Prime Minister) is chosen from the legislature. (e.g., UK, Canada)

Presidential System: The executive (President) is elected separately from the legislature. (e.g., USA, Brazil)



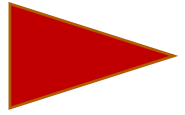
1. Democracy

- The term "democracy" is derived from the Greek words demos (people) and kratos (power), meaning "power of the people." In a democracy, the government is elected by the people.
- Herodotus defined democracy as "a form of government in which the ruling power is vested in the whole community."
- Abraham Lincoln described democracy as "government of the people, by the people, and for the people."

Types of Democracy

Direct Democracy: Citizens vote directly on all public matters.
Example: Found in some Swiss cantons (semi-direct democracy).

Representative Democracy: Citizens elect representatives to make decisions.
Example: USA, UK, Canada.



1. Democracy

Merits of Democracy

- Ensures equality and public participation.
- Promotes accountability and political education.
- Encourages reforms and good governance.

Demerits of Democracy

- Can lead to rule by incompetent leaders.
- Costly administration and political instability.
- Risk of majority domination over minorities.

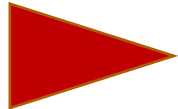
The Relationship Between Democracy & Civil Society

A strong democracy depends on an active civil society—groups and individuals working outside the government to promote social and political change. **Civil society includes non-governmental organizations (NGOs), labor unions, student groups, and volunteer organizations.**

How Civil Society Strengthens Democracy

- **Holds the Government Accountable:** Civil society organizations monitor government actions and expose corruption.
- **Advocates for Social Justice:** Groups push for laws that protect human rights, gender equality, and minority rights.
- **Encourages Political Participation:** Civic groups educate people about elections and policies.
- **Provides Public Services:** NGOs fill gaps where governments may be lacking, such as disaster relief or education.

For example, civil society organizations in South Africa played a crucial role in ending apartheid, showing how public engagement can create positive change in governance.



2. Dictatorship

A dictatorship is a form of government where power is concentrated in a single leader or ruling party, often obtained through force.

Examples: Italy: Benito Mussolini (1922). Germany: Adolf Hitler (1933).

Causes of Dictatorship

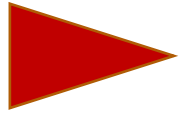
- Political instability and ineffective democratic governance.
- Economic crises and social unrest.

Merits of Dictatorship

- Establishes strong and stable government.
- Implements rapid economic and social reforms.

Demerits of Dictatorship

- Leads to absolute control with no checks on power.
- Suppresses individual freedoms and democratic values.



3. Monarchy

A monarchy is a government where sovereignty is embodied in a single ruler, the monarch.

Types of Monarchy

- Absolute Monarchy: The monarch has unlimited power (e.g., Saudi Arabia).
- Constitutional Monarchy: The monarch's power is limited by a constitution (e.g., the UK, Japan).

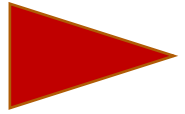
Examples: Saudi Arabia (Absolute Monarchy). United Kingdom, Japan (Constitutional Monarchy)

Advantages of Monarchy

- Promotes national unity and stability.
- Reduces political conflicts.

Disadvantages of Monarchy

- Can limit democratic participation.
- Hereditary rule does not guarantee competent leadership.



4. Theocracy

A theocracy is a government in which religious leaders rule in the name of a divine authority.

Examples: Iran, Vatican City

Advantages of Theocracy

- Provides moral governance.
- Promotes social unity.

Disadvantages of Theocracy

- Limits personal freedoms and diversity of beliefs.
- May lead to religious oppression.



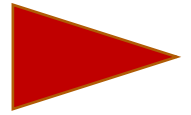
Whats is Community Engagement?

Community engagement refers to the process of **working collaboratively with community members**—whether individuals, groups, or organizations—to address issues that affect the well-being of those communities. **It involves building relationships, understanding community needs and concerns, and involving community members in decision-making processes.**

The goal of community engagement is to create positive outcomes by developing a **sense of belonging, mutual respect, and shared responsibility** among community members. It often leads to stronger, more resilient communities where people are actively involved in shaping their own futures.

Community engagement can take various forms, including:

- **Public Participation:** Involving community members in decision-making processes, such as through public consultations, town hall meetings, or participatory budgeting.
- **Volunteerism:** Encouraging individuals to contribute their time and skills to support community projects, local organizations, or social causes.
- **Partnerships:** Forming collaborations between organizations, businesses, and community groups to address specific issues or achieve common goals.
- **Education and Awareness:** Informing and educating the community about important issues, policies, or services, often to empower individuals to take action or make informed decisions.
- **Advocacy:** Supporting or representing the interests of a community to influence public policy or bring about social change.



Ways the Government Supports Civic Engagement

- **Encouraging Participation:** Governments create laws that allow people to vote, protest, and join civic organizations.
- **Providing Public Services:** Education, healthcare, and social welfare programs empower people to contribute to society.
- **Protecting Rights:** Laws ensure that citizens have freedom of speech, assembly, and access to justice.
- **Supporting Community Initiatives:** Governments fund local projects, charities, and volunteer programs that enhance civic life.

For example, in a democracy, governments encourage voting and participation in discussions about policies, while in authoritarian states, civic engagement is often limited by strict regulations.

Whats is The Importance of Civic Responsibilities?

Civic responsibilities are the duties and obligations that individuals have as members of a society, particularly within a democratic system. These responsibilities are essential for the functioning and sustainability of a democratic society.

1. Maintaining Democracy

Participation in Governance: Civic responsibilities, such as voting, participating in public discourse, and staying informed about political issues, are fundamental to the functioning of a democracy. When citizens fulfill these duties, they contribute to a government that reflects the will of the people.

Accountability: Citizens who actively engage in civic responsibilities help hold public officials accountable, ensuring that government actions align with the public's interests and values.

2. Promoting Social Cohesion

Community Involvement: Engaging in community activities and fulfilling civic responsibilities helps build a sense of belonging and mutual respect among citizens. It fosters social ties and promotes unity within diverse communities.

Collective Problem-Solving: Civic responsibilities encourage individuals to work together to address common issues, leading to more effective solutions that benefit the entire community.

► Whats is The Importance of Civic Responsibilities?

3. Protecting Rights and Freedoms

Safeguarding Liberties: Civic responsibilities like obeying laws, paying taxes, and serving on juries are crucial for upholding the rule of law, which protects individual rights and freedoms.

Advocating for Change: By fulfilling their civic duties, citizens can advocate for reforms and improvements, ensuring that the rights and freedoms of all individuals are respected and protected.

4. Fostering Ethical Governance

Promoting Transparency and Integrity: When citizens engage in civic responsibilities, such as monitoring government actions and reporting corruption, they contribute to a more transparent and ethical government.

Encouraging Responsible Leadership: Active civic engagement helps promote leaders who are responsive to the needs of their constituents, leading to more responsible and effective governance.



Whats is The Importance of Civic Responsibilities?

5. Ensuring Social Justice

Addressing Inequality: Civic responsibilities often include advocating for social justice and ensuring that all members of society have equal access to opportunities and resources.

Empowering Marginalized Groups: Active civic participation can empower marginalized communities, giving them a voice in the decision-making processes that affect their lives.

6. Supporting Public Services

Contributing to Public Goods: Responsibilities such as paying taxes are vital for funding public services like education, healthcare, infrastructure, and security, which benefit society as a whole.

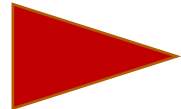
Participating in Public Life: Volunteering and community service contribute to the well-being of society, helping to address social needs and improve the quality of life for all.

Importance of Political Participation

Political participation means actively taking part in political processes to influence decisions. It is essential for democracy and allows citizens to shape their government.

Forms of Political Participation

- **Voting:** The most direct way citizens influence government policies.
- **Joining Political Parties:** Becoming a member of a party to support policies and candidates.
- **Protests and Demonstrations:** Expressing opinions on public issues through peaceful marches and rallies.
- **Engaging in Public Discussions:** Writing to government representatives, signing petitions, or debating policies.
- **Running for Office:** Citizens can contest elections to directly contribute to governance.



Why Political Participation Matters?

- **Strengthens Democracy:** When more people engage, governments become more representative and accountable.
- **Promotes Social Change:** Activism and advocacy have led to major reforms (e.g., Civil Rights Movement in the U.S.).
- **Prevents Corruption:** A politically aware and engaged public can hold leaders accountable.
- **Gives a Voice to Marginalized Groups:** Ensures that minorities and disadvantaged communities have representation.

